



YOU ARE **39 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**
6 days to go...

YOUR BABY TODAY

If you are having a planned Cesarean delivery, this is usually offered now—in order to balance the chance of labor starting unexpectedly with that of delivering your baby too soon. It is best for babies to be delivered as close to the due date as possible.

“It’s good to revisit your birth plan at this late stage since you may feel differently now about some of the requests you made.”

A birth plan is usually filled in earlier in pregnancy, and reviewed at 36 weeks (see [Your birth plan](#) and [Making a birth plan](#)). Now that the birth is imminent, look over it with your partner to consider things like your preferred method of pain relief, how you would like to be directed in pushing, and any other interventions that might be needed during labor. Adapt your birth plan as needed and discuss any changes or new concerns with your doctor.

Since your partner will be your advocate in labor, putting your requests forward to your labor nurses and doctor if you’re unable to express them, it’s important that they understand your wishes and they’re fresh in mind.

Remember, though, that you won’t really know how you’ll feel or what you want until you’re in labor, so keep an open mind and be prepared to adapt your plans on the day if it’s in the best interests of your baby’s well-being.

Discuss with your partner how you think they can best help you, whether it be giving you a massage or holding your hand. Talk to them about your concerns, hopes, and expectations.

STAYING CLOSE

It can be difficult to think of anything but the birth this close to the end of pregnancy. Try to focus on other things:

- **Spend time with your partner:** Enjoy quality time together while it is still just the two of you.
- **Have sex:** you might feel you are too big, or too tired, but it is good to remind yourselves of your sexual relationship. And, you never know, having sex could just get your labor started (see [Induction of labor](#)).

ASK A DOCTOR

Can I refuse to be induced? You have a right to say no to any intervention, but generally, induction is recommended when there is a risk in continuing the pregnancy. Make sure you understand why an induction is being recommended. Your doctor will review the process with